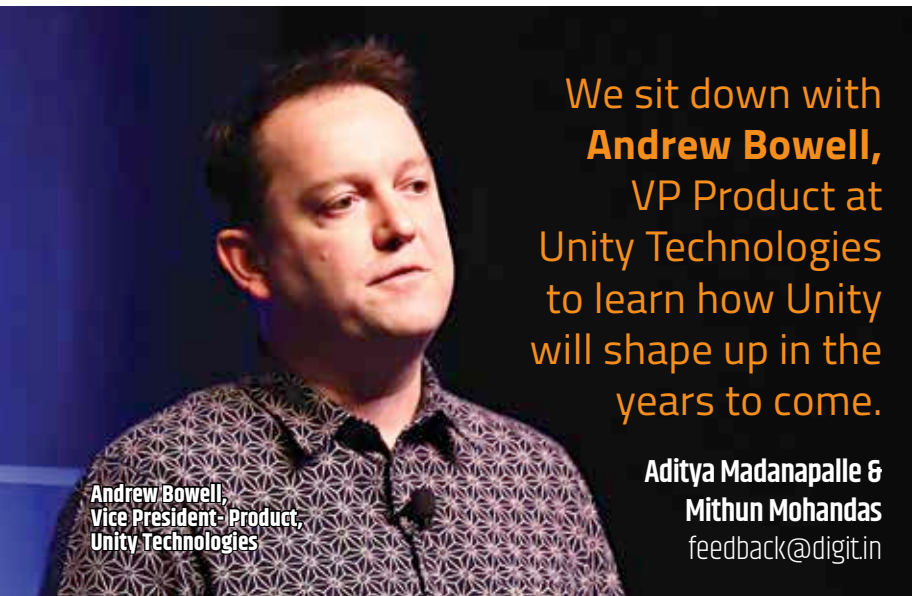


Understanding Unity's growth strategy



Andrew Bowen,
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We sit down with
Andrew Bowen,
VP Product at
Unity Technologies
to learn how Unity
will shape up in the
years to come.

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d When you decide on shipping releases, have there been any learnings that led to India specific features?

Andrew Bowen: Well I suppose one thing to say first is that we try to have one Unity. One of our goals is to have a single product to ship and we try not to create different product lines for different geographies. Unity is a very complex product already and we don't want to add to that complexity by having to manage lots of different products and SKUs. What we have done is create a package system which allows us to ship the core of Unity and then create packages, which are modules of functionality, which act as add-ons. It's possible to ship these independently from the main Unity core. What's good about this is that it also allows us to target geographies and have different strategies. For example, in India, since mobile is one of the predominant platforms here and the device range is very broad, one of the strategies we adopted is we get analytics data to help us optimise the engine for a broad range of handsets from the low-end to the high-end uniformly.

d One of the trends we observed at Unite 2018 was that folks like to get started on a game development process with Unity and switch over to another engine such as Unreal towards the end of the development process, primarily for the improvement in visual fidelity that the other engines offer.

Andrew Bowen: Right now, I'd say we're very competitive with Unreal from the graphics and rendering perspective. We definitely acknowledge the part about the Unity story is that in the 13 years since we founded the company, we've kind of gone through what we call good, better, best so we started off as a good engine. We had three principles. One was rapid iteration. So you can just easily drop an asset into Unity and within seconds it's in your scene, you can write some C# code to add some behaviour within 30 seconds and 30 minutes later you can have a little prototype up and running.

And the second thing we made sure of is that the platform is extensible so you can extend very easily. And the third thing was, you could run on any platform. So, from the beginning. We've

had 'any platform' as our strategy. Now we support 36 platforms which is more than any other engine and there's a fourth area – our community.

If you run into a problem with Unity. You can Google it, the answer at the top link will probably fix your issue. So we came from this place. If you imagine a pyramid where we're dealing with a lot of a lot of users. And as you go up, you get the people who want the leading graphics. It's a smaller market at the top of this pyramid and we're now there. Unity in the last year or 18 months has added new rendering architecture – our scriptable rendering pipelines – and this is a way for us to keep the extensibility of Unity because we've moved about half of our rendering into C#.

Then we shipped what we're calling our high definition rendering pipeline and this is specifically targeted for high end PCs, mobiles – what people mean by leading graphics. They also need a leading piece of hardware to do it on. So we have full support for the state of the art graphics features in Unity. I honestly think we're at the top, maybe along with Unreal and a couple of other nice engines. Users are realising that they can stick with Unity all the way.

d Epic being a technology company came out with its own store to rival Steam. Are there any plans for Unity to do come up with a game store?

Andrew Bowen: No, nothing that I can certainly talk about here. One thing I will say, though, is we're first and foremost a technology company. So we build game technology for developers to make great experiences to fuel the world with more creators and that's our number one mission. So, in that regard, our focus is very much on core products surrounded by things like our network and our ability to provide developers with a way to be successful. **d**